

Francis Alwyn Coomans

Cybersecurity Consultant (Offensive Security) | Senior IT Professional

OSCP, CPTS, CWES | 25+ Years in IT & Security

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Location: Gauteng, South Africa (Open to Remote, or International Opportunities)

Professional Summary

Cybersecurity & IT Professional with **25+ years of enterprise IT leadership**, infrastructure engineering, and governance experience, recently transitioned into **hands-on offensive security consulting**.

Combines deep operational knowledge (**AD, M365, networks, endpoints, audits, compliance**) with attacker methodology to identify real-world risk.

OSCP, CPTS, CWES certified; ranked **Top 1% (Pro Hacker)** on Hack The Box.

Seeking **remote, or international** opportunities for **Offensive Security, IT Manager, Head of IT, or hybrid security leadership roles**.

Key Achievements

- Achieved **Bachelor of Commerce in Business Informatics (Cum Laude)** while working full-time.
 - Ranked **Top 1% globally** on Hack The Box ("Pro Hacker") and HTB Academy.
 - Completed **OSCP, CPTS, CWES** certifications through intensive practical labs and exams.
 - Successfully completed **50+ simulated penetration tests** on HTB lab environments, producing technical findings and **key lessons learned**.
 - Transitioned from enterprise IT to full-time offensive security consulting, combining operational knowledge with attacker insight.
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Certifications

Certification	Provider	Year	Note
Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)	Offensive Security	2025	
Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS)	Hack The Box	2024	

Certification	Provider	Year	Note
Certified Web Exploitation Specialist (CWES)	Hack The Box	2023	
CompTIA PenTest+	CompTIA	2024	
CompTIA Security+	CompTIA	2023	
Mikrotik Certified Network Associate (MTCNA)	Mikrotik	2017	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>
Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)	Red Hat	2007	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>
Linux Professional Institute Certified (LPIC-1)	LPI	2007	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>

Technical Skills

Offensive Security & Adversary Simulation:

Penetration Testing, Red Teaming, Active Directory Exploitation, Enumeration, Web Fuzzing, Privilege Escalation, Lateral Movement, Kerberoasting, SQLi, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, Command Injection, File Inclusion, SSTI, IDOR, OWASP Top 10, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, BloodHound, Impacket, NetExec, Wireshark, Ligolo-ng, SysReptor.

Cybersecurity Operations & Risk Management:

Vulnerability Management, Risk Assessment & Reporting, Endpoint Protection, Patch Management, RBAC, Least Privilege (PoLP), Security Awareness Training, Internal IT Audits, Compliance Audits (Microsoft, Autodesk), Policy/Procedure Development, Incident Prevention.

IT Infrastructure & Systems Administration:

Active Directory, Group Policy, Microsoft 365, HCL Domino, Windows Server, Linux Administration, **Virtualization** (Hyper-V, XenServer), **Containers** (Docker), Backup Systems, Proxies, VPN Services, Email Systems.

Networking & Perimeter Security:

Routers, Switches, Network Segmentation (VLANs, Subnetting), Firewalls, TCP/IP, Secure Remote Access (VPNs).

Leadership, Projects & Automation:

IT Team Leadership, Mentorship, Multi-Site IT Operations, IT Project Management, Vendor Management, Python, PowerShell, Bash Automation.

Professional Experience

Founder & Offensive Security Consultant | Netrunnerz (Pty) Ltd – Gauteng, South Africa

Jun 2023 – Present

- Founded and operate **Netrunnerz (Pty) Ltd**, an offensive security consultancy.
- Delivered paid VMware ESXi root-password recovery engagement for an enterprise client.
- Consulted on and implemented **GFI LanGuard** for **Microsoft patch management** in an enterprise environment, including deployment, configuration, and reporting.
- Provide licensing, deployment, and support services for **GFI LanGuard** and **GFI KerioControl**.
- Executed **50+ full-chain simulated penetration tests** on Hack The Box platforms (**SQLi, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, command injection, Kerberoasting, pivoting, lateral movement**).
- Publish professional client-style **penetration test reports** for every retired Hack The Box machine completed (**executive summary, technical findings with screenshots, PoC code, and high-level remediation guidance**).
- Ranked **Pro Hacker (Top 1%)** on Hack The Box and **Top 1%** on HTB Academy.
- Daily driver tools: Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Metasploit, BloodHound, NetExec, Impacket, SysReptor, Nmap, Rustscan, Nessus.

Group IT Administrator / Senior IT Lead | ACTOM (Pty) Ltd – Gauteng, South Africa

Leading energy manufacturing and engineering group with 500+ employees across 10+ sites.

Nov 1997 – Apr 2023

Leadership & IT Service Delivery

- Delivered group-wide IT services across **10+ sites**, supporting 500+ users in a manufacturing and engineering environment.
- Mentored and supervised IT technicians; provided escalation support and technical leadership.
- Delivered ongoing **cybersecurity awareness training** to staff, including phishing and social engineering awareness.

Infrastructure & Systems Administration

- Administered **Active Directory and Group Policy**, enforcing RBAC and least-privilege (PoLP) access models.
- Managed enterprise systems including **Microsoft 365, HCL Domino, Windows Server, and Linux platforms**.
- Administered **endpoint protection and patch management** solutions across the group.
- Maintained Linux-based infrastructure supporting backups, proxies, and secure VPN services (OpenVPN).

Cybersecurity & Risk Management

- Implemented **network segmentation** using VLANs and subnetting to reduce lateral movement risk.
- Managed **firewalls and VPNs** to secure perimeter access and remote connectivity.

- Performed **internal vulnerability assessments** using OpenVAS/Greenbone as part of audit processes.
- Strengthened identity and access management through RBAC and security hardening initiatives.

Project Leadership & Delivery

- Designed and delivered **server room infrastructure**, overseeing planning, vendor coordination, and implementation.
- Led **multi-site IT infrastructure design and deployment**, including networks, servers, and security controls.
- Managed **ISP migrations and network service transitions**, ensuring minimal downtime.
- Led group-wide **endpoint protection replacement**, from evaluation to AD GPO deployment, completed in under six months.
- Planned and executed **HCL Domino to Microsoft 365 migration**, integrating Barracuda email security.

Audits, Compliance & Governance

- Conducted **bi-annual internal IT audits**, tracked findings, and implemented remediation plans.
- Reported audit outcomes and risk recommendations to senior management.
- Liaised with vendors including **Microsoft and Autodesk** during compliance audits.
- Improved audit processes covering **IT asset management, software licensing, and AD security**.
- Co-developed internal **IT policies, procedures, and audit questionnaires** with group IT management.

Automation & System Development

- Developed in-house automation and tooling using **Python, PowerShell, and Bash** to streamline IT operations and reduce manual workload.

Finance Clerk | Reumech/Reutech Head Office – Gauteng, South Africa

Defense manufacturer, part of a holding company, before restructuring.

1997

- Prepared daily cash flow reports and reconciliations.

Education

Bachelor of Commerce in Business Informatics (Cum Laude) | University of South Africa

2018 – 2021

- Graduated with 25 distinctions.
 - Coursework: Databases, Networks, Programming, Project Management, Internal Auditing.
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References

Available upon request.